

Confident English (B2 Upper-Intermediate)

A 13-week, 26-class English course for adults who already use English independently and want to sound confident. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you learn to tell layered stories, argue a case and handle disagreement, switch between formal and informal English, follow fast natural speech, and take part in a structured debate. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

LEVEL	DURATION	EACH CLASS	CONTENT
CEFR B2 · Upper-Intermediate	13 weeks · 26 classes	90 minutes · 2 × week	8 modules · 24 lessons

CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Every class has **one lesson** from the online course, except the two assessment classes. Lessons 4.3 and 8.3 are **review projects**: a present-argue-and-discuss task at the halfway point, and a structured debate at the end. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

WEEK 1		Layering the Past
Module 1:		telling stories in layers, and imagining how the past could have been different.
C1	1.1	Narrative Tenses — Past Perfect & Continuous past simple, past continuous, past perfect, past perfect continuous · by the time, just as, until ✓ I can tell a story that moves back and forth in time.
C2	1.2	The Third Conditional — Past Hypotheticals If I had..., I would have... · could / might have · second vs third · mixed conditionals ✓ I can talk about how things could have turned out differently.

WEEK 2**Regrets & Verb Patterns**

Modules 1–2: regrets and preferences, then which verb form follows which.

C3

1.3

Past Regrets — Wish, If Only, Would Rather & It's Time

wish + past perfect · wish + would · I'd rather you didn't... · it's (high) time we left

✓ I can express regrets, preferences, and things that are overdue.

C4

2.1

Gerunds & Infinitives

enjoy -ing vs decide to · preposition + -ing · purpose · remember, stop, try, regret, mean

✓ I can talk about my habits, goals, and memories with the right verb pattern.

WEEK 3**Deduction & Adapting to Change**

Module 2: reasoning about the past, and talking about getting used to new things.

C5

2.2

Modals of Deduction in the Past

must have / can't have / might have + past participle · should have for regret and criticism

✓ I can work out what must have happened, and say what should have happened.

C6

2.3

Used to / Be Used to / Get Used to

past habits vs familiar now vs adapting · base verb vs -ing · the “it” test

✓ I can describe a big change and how I adapted to it.

WEEK 4**Formal & Concise**

Module 3: the passive for formal reporting, and participle clauses for tighter sentences.

C7

3.1

The Passive — Advanced & Impersonal

passives across tenses and modals · It is said that... / He is said to have... · formal register

✓ I can report facts and beliefs in a formal, objective style.

C8

3.2

Relative & Participle Clauses

reduced relative clauses · -ing vs past participle · Having finished... · the dangling participle

✓ I can describe people, places, and processes concisely.

WEEK 5**Reporting & Linking**

Modules 3–4: reporting what people meant, and connecting ideas precisely.

C9

3.3

Reporting Verbs & Patterns

offer to · warn someone not to · admit / deny -ing · apologize for · accuse someone of

✓ I can report a conversation precisely, naming what each person did.

C10

4.1

Linking Ideas — Contrast, Cause & Result

although vs despite · because vs because of · so ... that / such ... that · however, therefore

✓ I can build a balanced argument with the right linkers.

WEEK 6**Emphasis & a Halfway Project**

Module 4: putting the spotlight where you want it, and the first review project.

C11

4.2

Adding Emphasis — Cleft Sentences & Inversion

It was ... who ... · What I need is ... · Never have I ... · Not only ... but also ...

✓ I can emphasize the point that matters most.

C12

4.3

Review Project — Present, Argue & Discuss

signposting a talk · building an argument · concede and counter · Modules 1–4 in action

✓ I can present an argument and defend it in discussion.

WEEK 7**Halfway Check & Future Milestones**

Module 5: a friendly progress test, then precise future forms.

C13

TEST**Progress Test 1 (Modules 1–4) + Catch-Up**

~50-min written check · 7-min pair speaking · catch-up stations

✓ I know what I do well and what to practice.

C14

5.1

Future Perfect & Future Continuous

will be + -ing · will have + past participle · by then, by the time · polite inquiries

✓ I can describe where I'll be and what I'll have done by a future point.

WEEK 8**Services & Precise Quantities**

Module 5: arranging services, and choosing exactly the right determiner.

C15

5.2

The Causative — Have / Get Something Done

have my car serviced · get it fixed · had my bag stolen · get someone to do

✓ I can talk about services I arrange and things that happen to me.

C16

5.3

Determiners & Quantifiers

all vs whole · every vs each · both, neither, either · most of, none of

✓ I can compare groups precisely, with the right agreement.

WEEK 9**Word Power & Nuanced Comparison**

Module 6: multiplying vocabulary, and comparing with precision.

C17

6.1

Word Formation — Prefixes, Suffixes & Word Families

decide → decision → decisive → decisively · un-, in-, im-, il-, ir-, dis- · shifting stress

✓ I can build the word form a sentence needs.

C18

6.2

Advanced Comparison

far / slightly + comparative · twice as ... as · the more ..., the better · better and better

✓ I can compare options and describe trends with nuance.

WEEK 10**Asking Skillfully & Switching Register**

Modules 6–7: polite questions, then moving between formal and informal English.

C19

6.3

Asking Skillfully — Indirect & Negative Questions

Could you tell me where it is? · if / whether · Isn't it...? · subject questions

✓ I can ask for information politely in any situation.

C20

7.1

Register — Formal vs Informal English

word choice · contractions · set phrases · the formal email · one register per message

✓ I can adapt my English to the person and the situation.

WEEK 11**Stories & Persuasion**

Module 7: telling a gripping anecdote, and making a persuasive case.

C21

7.2**Telling Stories & Anecdotes**

hooks and endings · just as, all of a sudden, before I knew it · direct speech · listener reactions

✓ I can tell an anecdote that keeps people listening.

C22

7.3**Making a Case — Presentations & Persuasion**

signposting · claim + evidence · rhetorical questions, tripling, contrast · handling questions

✓ I can give a short persuasive presentation and take questions.

WEEK 12**Natural Speech**

Module 8: decoding fast English, and sounding natural with vague language.

C23

8.1**Understanding Natural Speech**

weak forms and the schwa · linking · elision · gonna, wanna, kinda · can vs can't

✓ I can follow fast, informal English more easily.

C24

8.2**Vague Language & Being Approximate**

about, around, -ish, or so, thirty-odd · stuff, that kind of thing · sort of, a bit · when to be precise

✓ I can sound relaxed and natural in casual conversation.

WEEK 13**The Debate & the Finish Line**

Module 8: the capstone debate, the final test, and a celebration.

C25

8.3**Review Project — A Structured Debate**

arguments for and against · concede and counter · reasoned conclusion · the whole B2 toolkit

✓ I can take part in a structured debate and reach a reasoned conclusion.

C26

TEST**Final Test + Celebration**

~60-min written test · 8–10 min individual speaking interview · certificates

✓ I can show what I can do in English. 🎉

EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE

0:00	Warmer & review of the last class A speaking game that recycles last class's language
0:10	Presentation A dialogue, story, or discussion · meaning, form & pronunciation
0:30	Drill Listen and repeat: all together, then one by one
0:40	Controlled practice Workbook exercises, then check with a partner
0:55	<i>Break (5 min)</i>
1:00	Speaking Discussions, storytelling, role-plays, interviews, and presentations in pairs and groups
1:20	Feedback & “I can...” Fluency first, then kind error correction · tick the can-do checklist
1:25	Homework set-up The online lesson with  audio + one workbook page

COURSE DETAILS

■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR B1.** You can tell a story in the right past tenses, give and defend an opinion, report what people said, and handle work situations such as a complaint or a job interview.
- ◆ Finished **Independent English (B1)**? You're ready. New to our program? Take the shared **placement test** first.
- ◆ Learners who are still building basic reading and writing are welcome. Every lesson has literacy-support options, and the tests have an adapted version.
- ◆ No computer needed in class. A phone helps for homework, but it isn't required.

■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 24 lessons, in natural B2 English (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** with class and debate ground rules, what to bring, and QR codes to the online lessons
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, flashcards, role-play and debate cards, listening scripts, games, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: Confident English (B2), with  audio
- ◆ A free learning-tools page that shows how to translate lessons into any language

■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** an “I can...” checklist and short speaking checks, with no grades
- ◆ **Class 13 • Progress Test 1** (Modules 1–4): listening, vocabulary, grammar, reading, a reporting message, an argumentative paragraph, and a 7-minute pair speaking task with a short debate
- ◆ **Class 26 • Final Test** (all 8 modules): the same skills plus fast natural speech, a formal email and a balanced argument essay, and an 8–10 minute individual interview with a long turn, a discussion with push-back, and a register role-play
- ◆ Rubrics follow the CEFR B2 descriptors. Results decide the **next class**, never who gets to celebrate
- ◆ Tasks about your life can always use a “**new identity**” or an imagined story, and in debates you may argue an **assigned side** instead of your own view

■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **30–40 minutes**, with  Listen buttons for model sentences and dialogues
- ◆ Plus one **workbook page** to review the class
- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same language, so you can catch up
- ◆ After the course: Advanced English (C1) continues the same free ladder, all the way to C2. Business English and IELTS Preparation can run alongside

What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners reach **CEFR B2** and can use English with confidence, precision, and style, at work and in daily life:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ✓ Tell a layered story that moves back and forth in time | ✓ Talk about how the past could have been different, with regrets and preferences |
| ✓ Reason about what must, might, or can't have happened | ✓ Report facts, beliefs, and conversations in a precise, formal style |
| ✓ Build a balanced argument with accurate linkers and emphasis | ✓ Describe future milestones, services you arrange, and groups with precision |
| ✓ Build the right word form and compare options with nuance | ✓ Ask politely in any situation, and switch between formal and informal English |
| ✓ Tell an engaging anecdote and give a persuasive presentation | ✓ Follow fast natural speech, and take part in a structured debate |

Ray de la Paz

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v1.0 · 13 weeks · 26 classes · 39 instructional hours